

RULEBOOK

Porosity

Soak. Store. Survive.



PLAYERS

3 or 4

LENGTH

Up to 10 rounds

Designed by Harshat Verma

The idea

A city is growing on the coast, and the sea is rising to meet it.

In Porosity, each player shapes their own corner of that city. You raise buildings, plant parks and forests, dig ponds and wetlands, and build walls against the tide. Every round brings weather: a light shower, a heavy downpour, or a storm surge crashing in from the sea. And every few buildings, the sea rises and pushes further inland. How your city meets it is up to you.

Every square you build changes how your city meets the water. When the storms come, whose city will thrive?

What's in the game



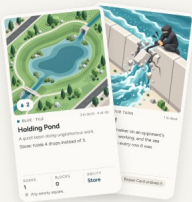
The board

A grid of squares with the sea along the bottom edge. 4 × 5 squares for 3 players, 5 × 6 for 4.



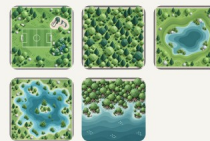
Water drops

The only currency. Spend them to build and act, earn them when your city soaks up water, keep them as points.



Cards

10 kinds of build card (buildings, green spaces, blue water spaces, sea walls) and 6 kinds of action card.



Tiles

Fill a whole square: Park, Forest, Holding Pond, Inland Wetland, Mangroves.



Buildings

Stacks of up to 3 floors on one square.



Tokens

Sit on a square you already own: a Green Roof on top of a building, or one Bioswale or Sea Wall on its edge.



The sea

It starts below the board. When it rises, it moves inland, changing the coastline your city is built on.

A few words used in these rules



Soaks

How many drops a piece absorbs each time water lands on it.



Standing water

Drops left on a square that it couldn't absorb. A square holds at most 3 (a Holding Pond holds 4).



Your square

Any square with your piece on it. You never build on someone else's square.



Front square

The square in each column closest to the sea. It moves inland as the sea rises.

Setup

- Each player picks a colour: **Clay, Sand, Plum or Rose.**



Clay Sand Plum Rose

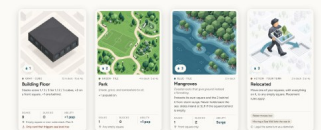
- Each player takes **8 water drops.**



- Place your starting buildings: **3 floors each (4 with 4 players).** Take turns placing one floor at a time on any empty square, or on top of one of your own, up to 3 high. They're free, and score exactly like buildings you build later.



- Shuffle all the cards together. **Deal 4 cards** to each player and turn **4 face up** as the market.



- Player 1 starts.**

Your turn

Do these steps in order.

1 Demolish

OPTIONAL · ONCE PER TURN

Clear one of your own squares. Pay the cost of every piece on it (a starting floor costs 1).



2 Take exactly one action

Play a build card. Pay its cost in drops and place the piece.

Play an action card. Choose its target, check the summary, confirm. You only pay on confirm, so cancelling is free.

Discard a card.

Pass. Your turn ends straight away and you don't draw.



3 Draw 1 card

From the market or the top of the deck. It's free. The market refills to 4.



You always end your turn holding **4 cards**.

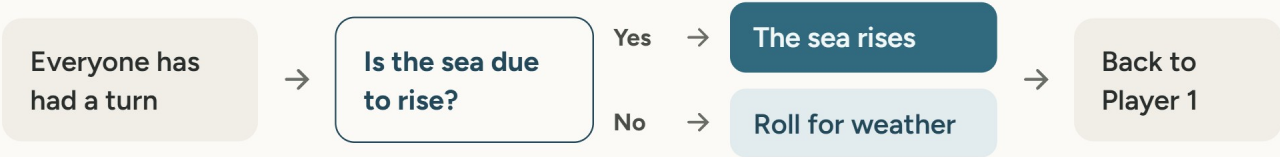
Where you can build



- Front squares: the row touching the sea
- Your squares (Clay)
- Another player's square: never build here
- A Sea Wall on the edge of a front square

- Never on another player's square, and never on the sea.
- Your pieces don't need to touch each other.
- Sea Walls and Mangroves go only on a front square.
- Inland Wetland never goes on a front square. If the sea later makes its square the front, it stays.
- One Green Roof on top of a building, plus one Bioswale or one Sea Wall on its edge. A Bioswale only goes on a building.

End of the round



The sea rises **or** the weather is rolled, never both. The weather roll passes clockwise each round; the last player in seat order rolls in round 1.

Weather

The roller rolls a 12-sided die. What each kind of weather means in a real city: page 6.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
	Light Rain 6 sides		2 drops fall on one player's city.								
	Heavy Rain 4 sides		4 drops fall on one player's city.								
	Storm Surge 2 sides		2 drops hit every owned square in the two squares nearest the sea, in every column.								

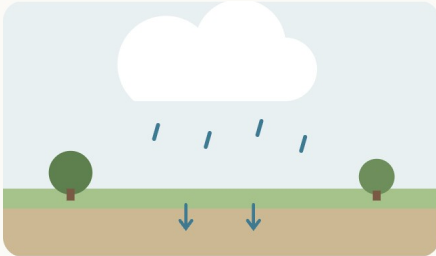
- Rain.** The roller picks who it falls on, and can pick themselves.
- Blocking.** The chosen player can play a Protection Card to refuse the rain. The roller then picks someone else.
- Storm Surge.** A column with Mangroves or a High Sea Wall is safe. Anything else in the front two squares gets hit. Each player can block the surge for their own city with a Protection Card.



Storm Surge: the shaded front two rows are hit, 2 drops on every owned square. The Mangroves column is safe.

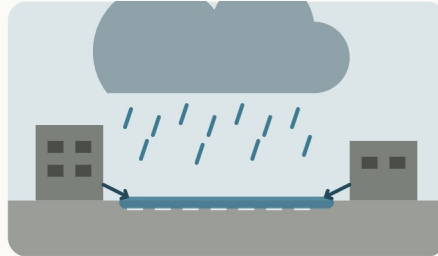
What the weather means

Water reaches a coastal city in two ways: from the sky and from the sea. The three weather events in the game are the ones real coastal cities face.



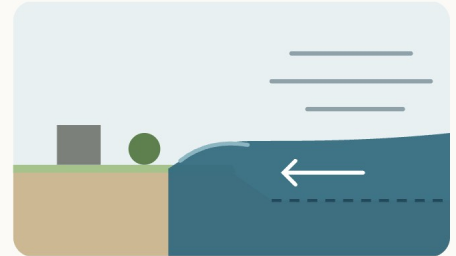
Light Rain

An ordinary shower: a little water, spread gently over the city.



Heavy Rain

A downpour or cloudburst: more water than the ground and drains can take in at once. On hard surfaces like roofs and roads, it runs off and collects in the streets.



Storm Surge

Happens during a storm, when strong winds push seawater up onto the shore. It floods the land nearest the coast for a short time, then drains back.

What sea level rise means



As the climate warms, glaciers and ice sheets melt and ocean water expands, so the sea slowly rises. Unlike a storm, it doesn't drain away: land that goes under stays under. Coastal cities around the world are already deciding how to respond. **In the game, each rise moves the coastline one square inland.**

Where the water goes

When water lands on your city, it settles in this order.

- 1



Place it. Put the drops on your squares, at most 3 per square (4 on a Holding Pond). Each drop that doesn't fit costs you 1 drop from your bank. If your bank is empty, you owe it, and pay it back from your next income.
- 2



Bioswales move it. Each Bioswale can pass up to 2 extra drops to a neighbouring square of yours.
- 3



Wetlands collect it. Each Inland Wetland pulls 1 extra drop from each neighbouring square of yours.
- 4



Squares soak it up. Each square absorbs up to its Soaks value, and you earn 1 drop for every drop absorbed.
- 5

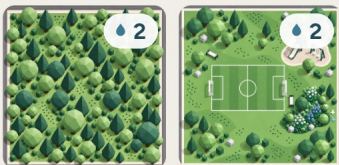


The rest stays. Leftover water stays on the square as standing water and gets another chance to soak in at the next weather.

 Water still on your squares at the end of the game counts against you.

Example: Heavy Rain falls on your city

1 · PLACE 4 DROPS



Forest

Park

2 on your Forest, 2 on your Park. Both fit, so nothing costs you.

2 · SOAK



Soaks 2

Soaks 1

Forest soaks 2, Park soaks 1. You earn 1 drop for each: +3 to your bank.

3 · RESULT



Dry

1 standing

+3 drops in your bank. 1 drop stays on the Park as standing water until the next weather.

The rising sea

When the sea rises, it moves inland, changing the coastline your city is built on. Why seas rise: page 6.

When it rises. Every 4th building floor anyone builds (every 5th with 4 players) makes the sea rise at the end of that round, instead of the weather. Starting floors don't count.



What happens

In each column, the sea takes the front square and destroys everything on it, unless a Sea Wall there holds it back.

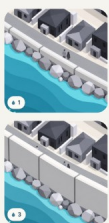
BEFORE THE RISE



AFTER THE RISE



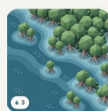
The front row is lost, except behind the Sea Wall, which uses up its hold. The Mangroves step back into the empty square behind them.



Sea Walls

Low Sea Wall holds back 1 rise. **High Sea Wall** holds back 2 and also stops Storm Surge.

A wall keeps count of the rises it holds back. When it runs out, or is sabotaged, moved or demolished, the sea immediately takes every square it was holding back.



Mangroves

Never stop the sea. They step back one square when it rises, if that square is empty. If they can't, they stay where they are, half under water, and keep working until the next rise destroys them.

1

2

3

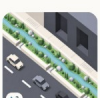
The third rise ends the game at the end of that round.

Build cards

● **Gray** cards build the city and defend it.

● **Green** cards soak up water where it falls.

● **Blue** cards move, store and collect water from other squares.

CARD	COST	SOAKS	WHAT IT DOES
 Building Floor ● Gray · Cube	1	0	A floor of your building, up to 3 high. The only card that makes the sea rise.
 Low Sea Wall ● Gray · Token	1	0	Holds back 1 sea rise. Front square only.
 High Sea Wall ● Gray · Token	3	0	Holds back 2 sea rises and stops Storm Surge. Front square only.
 Green Roof ● Green · Token	1	1	Sits on top of your building so it soaks up 1.
 Park ● Green · Tile	2	1	+1 population.
 Forest ● Green · Tile	3	2	+1 population.
 Bioswale ● Blue · Token	2	1	Goes on your building. Moves up to 2 extra drops to a neighbouring square, and links green and blue spaces together.
 Holding Pond ● Blue · Tile	2	1	Holds 4 drops instead of 3.
 Inland Wetland ● Blue · Tile	3	2	Pulls 1 extra drop from each neighbouring square of yours. Not on a front square.
 Mangroves ● Blue · Tile	3	1	Front square only. Protects itself and the 2 squares behind it from Storm Surge. Steps back when the sea rises.

Action cards

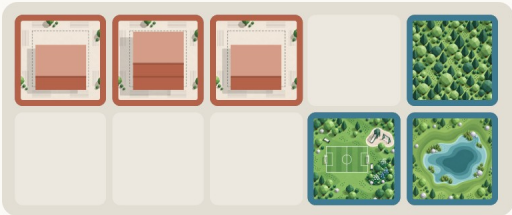
Play on your turn, except the two response cards.

CARD	COST	WHAT IT DOES
 Sabotage	4	Break an opponent's Sea Wall. The sea immediately takes every square it was holding back.
 Repair	4	Fix your own sabotaged Sea Wall. The sea pulls back and your drowned pieces return, with their water. Once per round.
 Relocated	3	Move one of your squares, with everything on it, to an empty square.
 Board Thief	2 (3 if the square touches its owner's other squares)	Swap one of your squares for an opponent's square, with everything on both.
 Protection RESPONSE	2	Refuse rain aimed at you, or Storm Surge on your city. Draw a new card.
 Stop Time RESPONSE	Free	When the sea is about to rise, take an extra build turn first, then refill your hand to 4.

Moving, swapping or demolishing a square with a Sea Wall counts as losing the wall, so the sea catches up.
Only Sabotage can be undone, with Repair.

Connecting your city

Squares connect when they share a side (not diagonally). Only your own squares connect.



-  Building group of 3: +2
-  Corridor of 3, green + blue: +2

Building groups. Buildings next to each other form a group. A group of n buildings scores $n - 1$ extra points: 2 buildings +1, 3 buildings +2, and so on.

Blue-green corridors. Your green spaces (Park, Forest) and blue spaces (Holding Pond, Inland Wetland, Mangroves) next to each other form a corridor. A building with a Bioswale joins it too. If a corridor has at least one green and one blue space, each green space in it soaks up 1 extra drop, and the corridor scores $n - 1$ points at the end.

A Green Roof doesn't link anything. The sea breaks a group, except for half-submerged Mangroves.

The extra soaking works during play; the $n - 1$ points are counted at the end of the game.

Scoring

At the end of the game, add up:

Buildings

Each building scores by its height, plus a bonus for being near the sea.

BUILDING	FRONT SQUARE	ONE BACK	FURTHER INLAND
 1 floor	3	2	1
 2 floors	5	4	3
 3 floors	7	6	5

Further inland

One square back

Front square

THE SEA

+1 **Green spaces:** each Park and Forest.

n - 1 **Groups and corridors:** each, as on page 10.

+1 **Drops in your bank:** each.

-1 **Standing water:** each drop still on your squares.

-1 **Debt:** each drop you still owe.

Rows are counted from each column's current front square, so they move inland as the sea rises.

End of the game

The game ends at the end of the round in which the sea rises for the third time, or after round 10, whichever comes first. **The highest score wins.**

IF TIED Least standing water wins → Most blue spaces → Share the win

The sea will rise. How your city meets it is up to you.